

DRAW — Keyboard & Mouse Shortcuts

Quick reference · v2.0.0 · 2026-08-26

Primary = Ctrl (Windows/Linux) or ⌘ Cmd (macOS). **Hold X + ...** = hold that key, then press/click/drag. **L/R/M-Click** = left / right / middle mouse · **Wheel** = scroll. Keys only do the listed thing when not typing in a text field.

Global / Application	
?	Open/close the Command Palette (searchable command list)
Ctrl+,	Open Settings dialog
Alt (tap & release)	Open/close the menu bar
Alt+X	Exit DRAW (prompts if unsaved)
Ctrl+Z	Undo
Ctrl+Y	Redo
Ctrl+Alt+N	New Window — another isolated DRAW instance (<i>Settings</i> → <i>General</i> → <i>Allow Multiple Instances</i>)
Ctrl+Alt+K	Cancel the running AI generation (aborts the batch) (<i>AI enabled</i>)

File	
Documents & images	
Ctrl+N	New canvas (prompts to save unsaved changes)
Ctrl+O	Open / import image (PNG, BMP, JPG, GIF)
Alt+O	Open DRAW project (.draw)
Ctrl+S	Save (silent if previously saved; dialog if new)
Ctrl+Shift+S	Save As (always prompts)
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+S	Export selection as cropped image
Ctrl+Shift+Q	QB64 Code Export — re-export to last project path (no dialog)
Alt+1 ... Alt+9	Open recent file #1–#9
Alt+0	Open recent file #10

Reference image	
Ctrl+R	Toggle reference image on/off (loads one if none)
Ctrl+Shift+Wheel	Adjust reference-image opacity (5–100%)

Reposition mode (View → Reposition Reference):

Drag

 move ·

Wheel

 scale ·

Arrows

 nudge 1px ·

Enter

 confirm ·

Esc

 cancel.

.draw

 files are PNG images with an embedded

drAw

 chunk preserving layers, blend modes, palette, tool state, reference image, and more. Standard image saves flatten visible layers. Full menu list: File menu (New from Template, Open Aseprite/PSD, Import ANSI, Export As, Export ANSI/Layer/Brush, Extract From/To Grid).

Edit · History · Clipboard	
Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y	Undo / Redo (Ctrl+Shift+Z also redoes)
Ctrl+C	Copy selection
Ctrl+Shift+C	Copy merged (all visible layers)
Ctrl+X	Cut selection (copy + clear with BG)
Ctrl+V	Paste at cursor (centered, engages Move)
Ctrl+Shift+V	Paste from OS clipboard
Ctrl+E	Clear/erase selection (BG color, or transparent for wand selections)
Ctrl+Alt+C	Copy to new layer
Ctrl+Alt+X	Cut to new layer
Delete	Clear (selection, or whole layer if none)
Backspace	Fill with foreground color
Shift+Backspace	Fill with background color

Paste workflow: select (

M

 /

W

) →

Ctrl+C

 /

Ctrl+X

 → move mouse →

Ctrl+V

 (auto-engages Move) → position →

Enter

 apply /

Esc

 cancel.

View · UI · Zoom · Pan

UI toggles

Tab	Toggle toolbar
Ctrl+L	Toggle layer panel
F4	Toggle preview window
F5	Toggle edit bar
Shift+F5	Toggle advanced bar
Ctrl+Shift+F5	Reload theme (hot-reload colors + icons)
Ctrl+M	Toggle Character Map panel
F10	Toggle status bar
F11	Toggle ALL UI
Ctrl+F11	Toggle menu bar
Ctrl+Shift+Up	Hide/show menu bar (alt binding)
Ctrl+Shift+Down	Hide/show status bar + color strip
Ctrl+Shift+Left	Hide/show left-side UI (edit bar, layers)
Ctrl+Shift+Right	Hide/show right-side UI (toolbar, organizer, drawer)
#	Toggle canvas border
Shift (hold)	Show crosshair while held
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+G	Toggle grayscale preview
Ctrl+Alt+O	Toggle CRT effect overlay

Zoom & pan

Ctrl+0	Reset zoom to 100% and center
Ctrl+=	Zoom in (25 → 50 → 100 → 200 → 300... 800%)
Ctrl+-	Zoom out
Wheel	Zoom in/out at cursor
Hold Z + 1...9	Zoom preset 100 / 200 / 300 / 400 / 500 / 600 / 700 / 800 / 1600%
Hold Z + 0	Zoom 3200%
Shift+Wheel	Vertical pan
Shift+Arrows (no selection)	Pan viewport
M-Click + Drag	Pan canvas
Space + L-Click	Pan canvas
Dbl M-Click	Reset zoom & pan

Zoom snap levels: 25, 50, 100, 200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700, 800%.

Display Scale (window size): Settings (Ctrl+,) → Display → UI Scale (0 =auto, 1 – 8).

Tools

Press a letter to select a tool. Shift+Letter picks the filled/variant form.

B	Brush	Freehand painting (drag)
D	Dot	Single-pixel stamp (click)
L	Line	Straight lines
R / Shift+R	Rectangle / Filled	Outline / filled
C / Shift+C	Ellipse / Filled	Outline / filled
P / Shift+P	Polygon / Filled	Outline / filled
Q	Bezier	Cubic curves (drop anchors, drag handles)
F	Fill	Flood fill (Shift samples merged canvas)
K	Spray	Spray paint
E / Hold E	Eraser / temp Eraser	Tap = permanent; hold = while held
I	Picker	Eyedropper with loupe
M	Marquee	Rectangular selection
W	Magic Wand	Contiguous same-color select
V	Move	Move/transform selection
Z	Zoom	Click in / Alt +click out / drag region
T / Shift+T / Ctrl+T	Text (VGA / Tiny5 / custom font)	
?	Command Palette	

Smart Shapes and **3D Text** are on the toolbar's Smart Shapes flyout (long-press / right-click): Polygon, Pie/Donut, Rounded Rect, Tab, Pill, Pac-Man, 3D Dice, Bevel Rect, Arrow, 3D Text.

Left vs right button: L-Click draws with FG, R-Click draws with BG (Brush, Dot, Line, Rect, Ellipse, Fill, Spray). Exceptions: Picker R-Click picks BG; Polygon R-Click closes shape; Brush/Dot **Shift** +R-Click draws a connecting line from the last point.

Drawing Modifiers

Shape constraints (while dragging)

Line / Rect / Ellipse	Shift	Constrain to H/V
Brush / Spray	Shift	Constrain to H/V axis
Line / Polygon	Ctrl+Shift	Angle-snap + bypass grid snap
Rectangle	Ctrl	Perfect square
Rectangle	Shift (from center)	Draw from center
Ellipse	Ctrl	Perfect circle
Ellipse	Shift (from center)	Draw from center

Subdivisions (while dragging a Rect / Ellipse / Line)

→ / ←	+/- column divider	+/- spoke	+/- radial spoke
↓ / ↑	+/- row divider	+/- concentric ring	—

(Rect up to 32/axis; Ellipse up to 16 spokes/rings; Line up to 16 spokes. Counts reset each drag.)

Angle snapping

Ctrl+Shift (hold while dragging/clicking) snaps to angle increments and bypasses grid snap. Increment set by **ANGLE_SNAP_DEGREES** in **DRAW.cfg** (default 45° → 8 directions; also 30/15/90°). Applies to Line, Polygon, Polygon-Filled, and Brush/Dot **Shift** +R-Click connecting lines.

Line end caps (while dragging Line)

s cycle start cap · **e** cycle end cap (none → arrow → diamond → circle → square → ...).

Smart Shapes (while dragging)

↑ / **↓** primary parameter · **←** / **→** secondary parameter · **Shift** constrain aspect · **Space** reposition without resizing · **Wheel** adjust primary. **3D Dice/Text lighting:** **W** / **S** tilt · **A** / **D** (or **Q** / **E**) orbit · **=** / **-** push light · **Hold L** + 0-9 intensity preset. **Dice type:** **4** / **6** / **8** / **0** / **1** / **2** / **3** = D4/D6/D8/D10/D12/D20/D30; L-drag wireframe (FG), R-drag solid (BG faces + FG wireframe).

Selection · Marquee · Magic Wand

Selection tools

M	Rectangle marquee
W	Magic wand (contiguous same-color)
—	Freehand / Polygon / Ellipse select (toolbar or command palette)

Marquee mouse

L-Drag create · **Shift+Drag** add (union) · **Alt+Drag** subtract · drag corner/edge handle resize · drag inside move.

Magic wand mouse

L-Click select contiguous · **Shift+Click** add · **Alt+Click** subtract · **Hold E** + **Click** flood-erase to transparent ·

Hold F + **Click** flood-fill FG · **Hold W** + **Click** select from merged canvas.

Selection keyboard

Ctrl+A	Select all
Ctrl+Shift+I	Invert selection
Ctrl+H	Hide/show marching ants (selection stays active)
Hold M + = / Hold M + -	Expand / contract selection 1px
Hold M + Shift+= / Hold M + Shift+-	Expand / contract selection (large step)
Ctrl+D / Esc	Deselect (from any tool)
Arrows	Move selection box 1px
Shift+Arrows	Move selection box 10px
Ctrl+Arrows	Move content 1px (lifts/floats, Photoshop-style)
Ctrl+Shift+Arrows	Move content N px (NUDGE_N)
Ctrl+Alt+Arrows	Clone content 1px (keeps original)
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+Arrows	Clone content N px

As a clipping mask: an active selection clips all drawing tools to inside it. Grid snap (**;**) applies to marquee drags; **Ctrl+Shift** angle-snaps + bypasses grid for the start. Stroke Selection lives in Edit menu / command palette.

Layers · Groups · Symbols

Layer keyboard

Ctrl+L	Toggle layer panel
Ctrl+Shift+N	New layer (<i>Ctrl+N</i> is New Canvas)
Ctrl+Shift+D	Duplicate layer
Ctrl+Shift+R	Rename layer
Ctrl+Shift+Delete	Delete layer
Ctrl+PgUp / Ctrl+PgDn	Move layer up / down
Ctrl+Shift+] / Ctrl+Shift+[	Arrange to top / bottom
Ctrl+Alt+E	Merge down
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+E	Merge all visible
Ctrl+G	New empty group
Ctrl+Shift+G	Group from selection (2+ layers)
Ctrl+Shift+U	Ungroup
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+C	Copy Layer to clipboard (for another DRAW window)
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+V	Paste Layer as new layer

Layer panel mouse

L-Click select · **Ctrl/Shift+L-Click** add/remove from multi-selection · **R-Click** select+rename · **Shift+R-Click** cycle blend mode · **Alt+L-Click** eye solo · **Click** eye toggle visibility · **Drag** across eyes swipe show/hide · **Click** lock opacity lock · **Click/Drag** opacity bar adjust · **Drag** row reorder · **Wheel**

19 blend modes (Shift+R-Click a row to cycle). Groups have their own opacity/blend (Pass-Through default) and can nest. Symbol layers link a parent to children (Layer menu: Convert to Symbol, Add Instance, Sync, Rasterize, Detach, Select Parent).

Middle-click the Text toolbar icon → load TTF/OTF. **TheDraw (TDF)**
 fonts: [TDF] text-bar button / Tools → TheDraw Font / palette tdf .
 Browser keys: type filter · Tab cycle focus · ↑/↓ move ·

PgUp/PgDn page · Home/End first/last · F2 favorite · Enter use · Esc cancel. **CBF** (color bitmap) fonts chosen from the font dropdown.

Brush · Custom Brush · Spray

Brush

[/]	Brush size – / + (fine, ±1)
Ctrl+Wheel	Brush size presets (1/3/5/7)
`	Toggle brush preview / cursor visibility
\	Toggle brush shape / cursor shape
F6	Toggle pixel-perfect mode

Custom brush

Ctrl+B	Capture selection as custom brush / clear when brush active
F9	Toggle recolor mode (paint brush in FG)
Shift+0	Apply 1px outline in BG (disables recolor)
F12	Export custom brush as PNG
Home / End	Flip custom brush H / V
PgUp / PgDn	Scale custom brush up / down
/	Reset custom brush scale

When a **custom brush** is active, Home / End / PgUp / PgDn / > / < / / transform the *brush* instead (see [Custom Brush](#)).

Move tool (V)

Arrows move 1px · Shift+Arrows 10px · Ctrl+Arrows scale 1px · Ctrl+Shift+Arrows scale 10px · Alt (hold) clone mode · Shift+Click select topmost layer at cursor & begin move · Enter apply · Esc cancel.

Edit → Transform overlay (Scale / Rotate / Shear / Distort / Perspective)

Drag handle apply mode · Enter apply & restore previous tool · Esc cancel. Shift: Scale=lock aspect · Rotate=snap 15° · Perspective=mirror opposite corner.

Image · Adjustments · Effects · CRT · AA

- Image menu:** Resize Canvas, Resize Image with Content (scales pixels too), Crop, Flip Canvas H/V, and adjustments (Brightness/Contrast, Hue/Saturation, Levels, Color Balance, Blur, Sharpen, Invert, Desaturate, Posterize, Pixelate). All adjustment dialogs: sliders + Wheel on slider fine-tune · OK / Enter apply · Cancel / Esc revert.
- Effects menu** (Shape / Texture / Render engines): each dialog has a split ORIG/ADJ loupe, wheel-sliders, an angle dial, seed, MIX slider, Reset. Effects can clip to selection or run selection-as-shape.
- Last-effect shortcuts:** Ctrl+F re-apply last effect · Ctrl+Alt+F recall last effect (re-open its dialog) · Ctrl+Shift+F blend/fade last effect (blend modes + isolate-to-new-layer).
- CRT effect:** Ctrl+Alt+0 toggle · View → CRT Effect Settings...
- Anti-Aliasing** (experimental, off by default): Edit → Anti-Aliasing toggle (status shows **AA**); Edit Bar Edge-Mode button (L-Click toggle, R-Click switch Pixel-Perfect ↔ AA). Config **ANTIALIAS**.
- Crop tool:** Click+Drag region · handles resize (drag outward past an edge to *grow* the canvas) · Arrows nudge · Ctrl+Arrows resize · Enter apply · Esc cancel.

Spray (K)

L-Click spray FG · R-Click spray BG · Shift constrain axis · brush size sets nozzle + radius (2× per level). Works with symmetry, selection clipping, and custom brushes.

Transform · Move

Universal transforms (current layer / selection / float — no tool needed)

H / Home	Flip horizontal
Ctrl+Shift+H / End	Flip vertical
> / <	Rotate 90° CW / CCW
PgUp / PgDn	Scale 2× / scale 50%
Ctrl+Home / Ctrl+End	Scale 2× horizontal / vertical (per-axis pixel-double)

Panels · Docking

Docking

Ctrl+Shift+Click a panel → toggle dock side (left ↔ right). Panels: Toolbox, Layer Panel, Edit Bar, Advanced Bar, Character Map (View → Layout menu).

Preview window (F4)

Follow / Floating-Image modes (View → Preview Window).

Alt+Click pick FG (CP enabled) · Alt+R-Click pick BG · Wheel zoom preview · drag title move · drag handle resize.

Drawer panel

F1/F2/F3 Brush/Gradient/Pattern mode · L-Click slot select · Shift+L-Click store current · R-Click context menu · M-Click cycle mode · Shift+M-Click clear slot · Shift+R-Click import into slot · L/R-Click mini palette set FG/BG.

Color Mixer / Image Browser

View → Color Mixer (RGB/HSV sliders, hex). View → Browser:

Click select · Ctrl+Click multi-select · DbL-Click load · drag file → canvas/drawer/layer-panel · Wheel scroll · DbL-Click title maximize.

Audio · Music

}	Next track
{	Previous track
*	Play a random track

Everything else is in the **Audio** menu: Sound FX toggle/volume/mute, Music toggle/volume/mute, Random Track (per format), Explore Music, Now Playing. MIDI plays via OPL3 FM or a custom .sf2 (Settings → Audio → MIDI Soundfont).

Drag & Drop · Image Import

Where you drop decides what happens:

Canvas	Place on current layer (undoable)
Layer panel	New layer
Brush bin (drawer)	Custom brush in next free slot (new page if full)
Menu bar	Open in a separate DRAW window

Shift while dropping centers on canvas. Images larger than the canvas open the interactive **Image Import** flow.

Image Import controls: **Drag** placement marquee · **Shift+corner** constrained resize · **Wheel** zoom · **Arrows** move box 1px · **Shift+Arrows** 10px · **Ctrl+Arrows** resize · **Alt+Arrows** pan crop · **R-Drag** pan crop · **> / <** rotate · **Home / End** flip · **Enter** apply · **Esc** cancel.

Menu Bar · Command Palette

Menu bar

Alt (tap) open/close · **Ctrl+F11** toggle · **← / →** navigate menus · **↑ / ↓** items · **Enter** execute · **Esc** close. Each item shows its hotkey; toggles show checkmarks.

Command Palette (?)

Type to filter (subsequence/fuzzy) · **↑ / ↓** navigate · **Enter** execute · **Esc** close · **Backspace** delete char. **Smart case:** a lowercase query is case-insensitive; an ALL-CAPS query is a case-sensitive acronym match (e.g. **TDF** → the one TheDraw command).

Mouse Reference

Canvas (general)

L-Click / Drag	Draw/select with FG (tool-dependent)
R-Click	Draw with BG (Brush/Dot/Line/Rect/Ellipse/Fill/Spray)
M-Click + Drag	Pan
Dbl M-Click	Reset zoom & pan
Wheel	Zoom
Space + L-Drag	Pan
Ctrl+L-Click	Set symmetry center

Per-tool (canvas)

Zoom	L-Click in · Alt +L-Click out · L-Drag zoom-to-region
Picker	L/R-Click pick FG/BG · Alt +L/R-Click temporary pick (returns tool on Alt release)
Dot	Shift +R-Click line from last point
Marquee	drag handles resize · drag inside move · Shift / Alt +Drag add/subtract
Move	drag handles scale · drag inside move · Shift +Click pick topmost layer
Bezier	Click corner anchor · Click+Drag smooth anchor · Backspace remove last · Enter commit · Esc cancel · H handles

(Layer panel, palette, drawer, preview, browser, toolbar mouse: see their sections above.)

Toolbar button extras

Text: L=VGA, R=Tiny5, M=load custom font. Open: L=open project, R=import image. Pan: M/Dbl-Click resets zoom+pan. Dot: Dbl-L-Click clears custom brush.

Hold-Key Chords

Hold a **non-modifier** key, then click/press/drag. Easy to miss:

F	L/R-Click	Global fill (contiguous) with FG / BG across all visible layers
Shift+F	L/R-Click	Replace-all global fill (FG / BG)
E	Click	Flood-erase contiguous pixels to transparent
E	(as a tool)	Hold to erase, release to restore previous tool
W	Click	Magic-wand from merged canvas
G	Arrow	Resize grid width/height independently
L	0–9	Smart-Shape 3D light intensity preset
R	Click	Picker samples the reference image
Space	Drag	Pan (any tool); or reposition a Smart Shape while dragging